Text 1

第 1 段

Nearly 2,000 years ago, as the Romans began to pull out of Scotland, they left behind a curious treasure: 10 tons of nails, nearly a million of the things. The nail hoard was discovered in 1960 in a four-metre-deep pit covered by two metres of gravel.

直译：大约两千年前，当罗马人开始撤出苏格兰时，他们留下了一批奇特的财宝：十吨钉子，总数将近一百万枚。这批藏钉于一九六〇年在一个四米深的坑中被发现，坑上覆盖着两米厚的砾石。

第 2 段

Why had the Romans buried a million nails? The likely explanation is that the withdrawal was rushed, and they didn't want the local Caledonians getting their hands on 10 tons of weapon-grade iron. The Romans buried the nails so deep that they would not be discovered for almost two millennia.

直译：罗马人为什么埋下一百万枚钉子？最可能的解释是，撤退十分仓促，他们不想让当地的喀里多尼亚人得到十吨可用于制造武器的铁。罗马人把钉子埋得如此之深，以至于它们在近两千年之后才被发现。

第 3 段

Later civilisations would value the skilled blacksmith's labour in a nail even more than the raw material. As Roma Agrawal explains in her new delightful book Nuts and Bolts, early 17th-century Virginians would sometimes burn down their homes if they were planning to relocate. This was an attempt to recover the valuable nails, which could be reused after sifting the ashes. The idea that one might burn down an entire house just to reclaim the nails underlines how scarce, costly and valuable the simple-seeming technology was.

直译：后来的文明甚至更加看重一枚钉子中凝结的熟练铁匠劳动，而不是原材料本身。正如罗玛·阿格拉瓦尔在其有趣的新书《螺母与螺栓》中所解释的，十七世纪早期的弗吉尼亚居民，如果计划迁居，有时会烧掉自己的房屋。这是为了回收贵重的钉子；筛过灰烬后，它们可以再利用。仅仅为了取回钉子，竟可能烧掉整座房屋，这一想法凸显了这种看似简单的技术曾是多么稀缺、昂贵而有价值。

第 4 段

The price of nails fell by 90% between the late 1700s and mid-1900s, as economist Daniel Sichel points out in a research paper. According to Sichel, although the falling price of nails was driven partly by cheaper iron and cheaper energy, most of the credit goes to nail manufacturers who simply found more efficient ways to turn steel into nails.

直译：经济学家丹尼尔·西歇尔在一篇研究论文中指出，从十八世纪末到二十世纪中叶，钉子的价格下降了百分之九十。西歇尔认为，虽然钉子降价部分是由更便宜的铁和能源推动的，但主要功劳应归于钉子制造商：他们不过是找到了把钢变成钉子的更高效方法。

第 5 段

Nails themselves have changed over the years, but Sichel studied them because they haven't changed much. Roman lamps and Roman chariots are very different from LED strips and sports cars, but Roman nails are still clearly nails. It would be absurd to try to track the changing price of sports cars since 1695, but to ask the same question of nails makes perfect sense.

直译：这些年来，钉子本身也发生了变化，但西歇尔之所以研究它们，是因为它们的变化并不大。罗马油灯和罗马战车，与 LED 灯带和跑车差异极大，但罗马钉子仍然很清楚地是钉子。试图追踪自一六九五年以来跑车价格的变化，会很荒唐；但对钉子提出同样的问题，却完全合理。

第 6 段

I make no apology for being obsessed by a particular feature of everyday objects: their price. I am an economist, after all. After writing two books about the history of inventions, one thing I've learnt is that while it is the enchantingly sophisticated technologies that get all the hype, it's the cheap technologies that change the world.

直译：我并不为自己痴迷于日常物品的某一特征——它们的价格——感到抱歉。毕竟，我是一名经济学家。在写了两本关于发明史的书之后，我学到的一点是：虽然得到一切大肆宣传的，是那些复杂精妙、令人着迷的技术，但改变世界的，却是便宜的技术。

第 7 段

The Gutenberg printing press transformed civilisation not by changing the nature of writing but by changing its cost—and it would have achieved little without a parallel collapse in the price of surfaces to write on, thanks to an often-overlooked technology called paper. Solar panels had a few niche uses until they became cheap; now they are transforming the global energy system.

直译：古腾堡印刷机之所以改变文明，不是因为它改变了书写的本质，而是因为它改变了书写的成本。如果没有一种常被忽视、名叫纸的技术，使承载书写的材料价格同步大幅下降，印刷机也不会取得多大成就。太阳能电池板在变得便宜之前，只有少数小众用途；如今，它们正在改变全球能源系统。

Text 2

第 1 段

Parenting tips obtained from hunter-gatherers in Africa may be the key to bringing up more contented children, researchers have suggested. The idea is based on studies of communities such as the Kung of Botswana, where each child is cared for by many adults. Kung children as young as four will help to look after younger ones and "baby-wearing", in which infants are carried in slings, is considered the norm.

直译：研究人员提出，从非洲狩猎采集者那里获得的育儿经验，可能是养育更快乐满足的儿童的关键。这一观点基于对博茨瓦纳昆族等群体的研究；在那里，每个孩子都由许多成年人照顾。昆族儿童小至四岁就会帮助照看更小的孩子，而用背带把婴儿带在身上的“贴身背婴”做法，也被视为常态。

第 2 段

According to Dr Nikhil Chaudhary, an evolutionary anthropologist at Cambridge University, these practices, known as alloparenting, could lead to less anxiety for children and parents.

直译：剑桥大学进化人类学家尼基尔·乔杜里博士指出，这些被称为“异亲抚育”的做法，可以减轻儿童和父母的焦虑。

第 3 段

Dr Annie Swanepoel, a child psychiatrist, believes that there are ways to incorporate them into western life. In Germany, one scheme has paired an old people's home with a nursery. The residents help to look after the children, an arrangement akin to alloparenting. Another measure could be encouraging friendships between children in different school years to mirror the unsupervised mixed-age playgroups in hunter-gatherer communities.

直译：儿童精神科医生安妮·斯旺普尔博士认为，有一些办法可以把这些做法融入西方生活。在德国，一个项目把养老院与托儿所配对起来，老人帮助照顾孩子，这种安排类似异亲抚育。另一项措施可以是鼓励不同年级儿童之间建立友谊，以对应狩猎采集群体中无人专门监督的混龄游戏小组。

第 4 段

In a paper published in the Journal of Child Psychology and Psychiatry, researchers said that the western nuclear family was a recent invention which broke with evolutionary history. This abrupt shift to an "intensive mothering narrative", which suggests that mothers should manage childcare alone, was likely to have been harmful. "Such narratives can lead to maternal exhaustion and have dangerous consequences," they wrote.

直译：研究者在《儿童心理学与精神病学杂志》发表的一篇论文中说，西方的核心家庭是近期才出现的形式，打破了演化历史中的模式。突然转向“密集母职叙事”，即认为母亲应独自承担儿童照护，很可能有害。他们写道：“这样的叙事可能导致母亲精疲力竭，并产生危险后果。”

第 5 段

By contrast, in hunter-gatherer societies adults other than the parents can provide almost half of a child's care. One previous study looked at the Efe people of the Democratic Republic of Congo. It found that infants had an average of 14 alloparents a day by the time they were 18 weeks old and were passed between caregivers eight times an hour.

直译：相比之下，在狩猎采集社会中，父母之外的成年人可以承担接近一半的儿童照护。此前一项研究考察了刚果民主共和国的埃费人。研究发现，到十八周大时，婴儿平均每天有十四名非父母照护者，每小时会在照护者之间被传抱八次。

第 6 段

Chaudhary said that parents now had less childcare support from family and social networks than during most of humans' evolutionary history, but introducing additional caregivers could reduce stress and maternal depression, which could have a "knock-on" benefit to a child's wellbeing. An infant born to a hunter-gatherer society could have more than ten caregivers—this contrasts starkly to nursery settings in the UK where regulations call for a ratio of one carer to four children aged two to three.

直译：乔杜里说，与人类演化史的大部分时期相比，如今父母从家庭和社会网络获得的育儿支持更少。但引入额外照护者，可以减轻压力和母亲的抑郁，并进一步给儿童福祉带来连带好处。在狩猎采集社会出生的婴儿，可能拥有十名以上照护者；这与英国托育机构的情形形成鲜明对照：法规要求，两至三岁儿童的照护比例为一名照护者对应四名儿童。

第 7 段

While hunter-gatherer children learnt from observation and imitation in mixed-age playgroups, researchers said that western "instructive teaching", where pupils are asked to sit still, may contribute to conditions such as attention deficit hyperactivity disorder. Chaudhary said that Britain should explore the possibility that older siblings helping their parents "might also enhance their own social development."

直译：研究者说，狩猎采集群体的儿童通过混龄游戏小组中的观察与模仿学习，而西方的“指令式教学”要求学生安静坐着，可能促成注意缺陷多动障碍等状况。乔杜里说，英国应探索这样一种可能性：年长的兄弟姐妹帮助父母，“也可能促进他们自身的社会性发展”。

Text 3

第 1 段

A Polish digital artist who uses classical painting styles to create dreamy fantasy landscapes, Greg Rutkowski has made illustrations for games such as Dungeons & Dragons and Magic: The Gathering. And he's become a sudden hit in the new world of text-to-image AI generation.

直译：格雷格·鲁特科夫斯基是一位波兰数字艺术家，他运用古典绘画风格创作梦幻的幻想风景，曾为《龙与地下城》《万智牌》等游戏绘制插图。而在新兴的文字生成图像人工智能领域，他突然走红了。

第 2 段

His distinctive style is now one of the most commonly used prompts in the new open-source AI art generator Stable Diffusion, which was launched late last month. The tool, along with other popular image-generation AI models, allows anyone to create impressive images based on text prompts. For example, type in "Wizard with sword and a glowing orb of magic fire fights a fierce dragon Greg Rutkowski," and the system will produce something that looks not a million miles away from works in Rutkowski's style.

直译：他鲜明的风格，如今成了新开源人工智能绘画生成器 Stable Diffusion 最常用的提示词之一；该工具于上个月晚些时候推出。它与其他流行的图像生成 AI 模型一样，让任何人都能依据文字提示，创造令人印象深刻的图像。例如，输入“拿着剑、带有发光魔法火球的巫师与一条凶猛的龙搏斗，格雷格·鲁特科夫斯基”，系统就会生成某种看起来与鲁特科夫斯基风格作品相当接近的图像。

第 3 段

But these open-source programs are built by scraping images from the internet, often without permission and proper attribution to artists. As a result, they are raising tricky questions about ethics and copyright. And artists like Rutkowski have had enough.

直译：但是，这些开源程序通过从互联网上抓取图像而构建，往往未经艺术家许可，也没有恰当署名。因此，它们引发了关于伦理与版权的棘手问题。而鲁特科夫斯基这样的艺术家已经受够了。

第 4 段

According to the website Lexica, which tracks over 10 million images and prompts generated by Stable Diffusion, Rutkowski's name has been used as a prompt around 93,000 times. Some of the world's most famous artists, such as Michelangelo, Pablo Picasso, and Leonardo da Vinci, brought up around 2,000 prompts each or less. Rutkowski's name also features as a prompt thousands of times in the Discord of another text-to-image generator, Midjourney. Rutkowski was initially surprised but thought it might be a good way to reach new audiences. Then he tried searching for his name to see if a piece he had worked on had been published. The online search brought back work that had his name attached to it but wasn't his.

直译：根据追踪 Stable Diffusion 生成的超过一千万张图像及提示词的网站 Lexica，鲁特科夫斯基的名字已被用作提示词约九万三千次。米开朗琪罗、巴勃罗·毕加索和列奥纳多·达·芬奇等世界最著名艺术家，每人的名字出现在提示词中的次数约为两千次或更少。鲁特科夫斯基的名字，也在另一个文字生成图像工具 Midjourney 的 Discord 社群中，作为提示词出现了数千次。鲁特科夫斯基起初感到惊讶，但认为这也许是接触新受众的好办法。随后，他尝试搜索自己的名字，想看看自己参与创作的一件作品是否已经发表。搜索结果却返回了附有他名字、但并非他创作的作品。

第 5 段

“It’s been just a month. What about in a year? I probably won’t be able to find my work out there because the internet will be flooded with AI art,” Rutkowski says. “That’s concerning.”

直译：鲁特科夫斯基说：“这才过去一个月。一年之后呢？我可能都无法在网上找到自己的作品，因为互联网会被 AI 艺术淹没。这令人担忧。”

第 6 段

Other artists besides Rutkowski have been surprised by the apparent popularity of their work in text-to-image generators—and some are now fighting back.

直译：除了鲁特科夫斯基之外，其他艺术家也惊讶于自己的作品在文字生成图像工具中显得如此受欢迎，其中一些人现在开始反击。

第 7 段

Karla Ortiz, an illustrator based in San Francisco who found her work in Stable Diffusion’s data set, has been raising awareness about the issues around AI art and copyright. Artists say they risk losing income as people start using AI-generated images based on copyrighted material for commercial purposes. But it’s also a lot more personal, Ortiz says, arguing that because art is so closely linked to a person, it could raise data protection and privacy problems.

直译：旧金山插画师卡拉·奥尔蒂斯发现自己的作品出现在 Stable Diffusion 的数据集中，之后一直在提高人们对 AI 艺术与版权问题的认识。艺术家们说，当人们开始把基于受版权保护材料生成的 AI 图像用于商业目的时，他们就面临收入损失的风险。但奥尔蒂斯表示，这还涉及更加个人化的问题。她认为，因为艺术与个人联系如此紧密，这也可能引发数据保护与隐私问题。

第 8 段

“There is a coalition growing within artist industries to figure out how to tackle or mitigate this,” says Ortiz. The group is in its early days of mobilization, which could involve pushing for new policies or regulation. One suggestion is that AI models could be trained on images in the public domain, and AI companies could forge partnerships with museums and artists, Ortiz says.

直译：奥尔蒂斯说：“艺术行业内部正形成一个联盟，研究如何处理或减轻这一问题。”该团体处于动员的早期阶段，可能会推动新政策或监管规定。奥尔蒂斯说，一项建议是，AI 模型可以用公有领域的图像训练，而 AI 公司可以与博物馆和艺术家建立合作关系。

Text 4

第 1 段

The miracle of the Chesapeake Bay lies not in its depths, but in the complexity of its natural construction, the interaction of fresh and saline waters, and the mix of land and water. The shallows provide homes for hundreds of species while storing floodwaters, filtering pollutants from water, and protecting nearby communities from potentially destructive storm surges.

直译：切萨皮克湾的奇妙之处，不在于其深度，而在于其自然构造的复杂性、淡水与咸水的相互作用，以及陆地与水域的交织。浅水区为数百种物种提供栖息地，同时蓄积洪水、滤除水中污染物，并保护附近社区免受可能具有破坏性的风暴潮侵袭。

第 2 段

All this was put at great risk late last month, when the U.S. Supreme Court issued a ruling in an Idaho case that provides the U.S. Environmental Protection Agency (EPA) far less authority to regulate wetlands and waterways. Specifically, a 5-4 majority decided that wetlands protected by the EPA under its Clean Water Act authority must have a "continuous surface connection" to bodies of water. This narrowing of the regulatory scope was a victory for builders, mining operators and other commercial interests often at odds with environmental rules. And it carries "significant repercussions for water quality and flood control throughout the United States," as Justice Brett Kavanaugh observed.

直译：上个月晚些时候，这一切都面临重大风险，因为美国最高法院在一宗爱达荷州案件中作出裁决，大幅削弱了美国环境保护局（EPA）监管湿地和水道的权力。具体而言，法院以五比四的多数决定，EPA 依据《清洁水法》所保护的湿地，必须与水体有 " 连续的地表连接 "。监管范围的这一缩小，是建筑商、矿业经营者及其他经常与环境规定冲突的商业利益方的一场胜利。正如大法官布雷特 · 卡瓦诺所指出的，它将 " 对全美国的水质和洪水控制产生重大影响 "。

第 3 段

In Maryland, the good news is that there are many state laws in place that provide wetlands protections. But that's a very shortsighted view, particularly when it comes to the Chesapeake Bay. The reality is that water, and the pollutants that so often come with it, don't respect state boundaries. The Chesapeake draws from a 64,000-square-mile watershed that extends into Virginia, Pennsylvania, New York, West Virginia, the District of Columbia and Delaware. Will those jurisdictions extend the same protections now denied under Sackett v. EPA? Perhaps some, but all? That seems unlikely.

直译：在马里兰州，好消息是已有许多州法律提供湿地保护。但这种看法非常短视，特别是在切萨皮克湾问题上。现实是，水及经常随之而来的污染物，并不遵守州界。切萨皮克湾汇集着一个面积六万四千平方英里的流域来水，这个流域延伸至弗吉尼亚、宾夕法尼亚、纽约、西弗吉尼亚、哥伦比亚特区及特拉华。这些辖区会不会提供在 " 萨克特诉环保局案 " 中如今被否定的同等保护？也许有些会，但所有地方都会吗？这似乎不太可能。

第 4 段

It is too easy, and misleading, to see such court rulings as merely standing up for the rights of land owners when the consequences can be so dire for their neighbors. And it's a reminder that the EPA's involvement in the Chesapeake Bay Program has long been crucial as the means to transcend the influence of deep-pocketed special interests in neighboring states. Pennsylvania farmers, to use one telling example, aren't thinking about next year's blue crab harvest in Maryland when they decide whether to spread animal waste on their fields, yet the runoff into nearby creeks can have enormous impact downstream.

直译：当后果可能给邻居带来如此严重的伤害时，仅把这类法院裁决看作维护土地所有者权利，既过于简单，也具有误导性。这也提醒我们：EPA 参与切萨皮克湾计划长期以来至关重要，因为它提供了一种手段，能够超越邻州财力雄厚的特殊利益集团的影响。举一个很有说明力的例子，宾夕法尼亚的农民在决定是否把动物粪便撒到田里时，并不会考虑马里兰州明年的蓝蟹收成；然而，流入附近溪流的地表径流，却可能对下游产生巨大影响。

第 5 段

And so we would call on state lawmakers from Richmond to Albany to consider reviewing their own wetlands protections and see for themselves the enormous stakes involved. We can offer them a visit to Blackwater National Wildlife Refuge in Dorchester County where bald eagles fly over tidal marshes so shallow you could not paddle a boat across them but teeming with aquatic life. It's worth the scenic drive.

直译：因此，我们呼吁从里士满到奥尔巴尼的各州立法者，考虑审查本州的湿地保护措施，并亲自了解其中牵涉的重大利害。我们可以请他们参观多切斯特县的黑水国家野生动物保护区；在那里，白头海雕飞过潮汐沼泽，这些沼泽浅得无法划船穿越，却充满水生生命。这值得人们沿风景优美的道路前往。